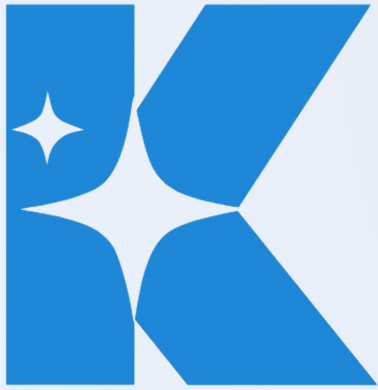




BEFORE Q4 HITS

38 firms a day close over late payments. Fix this first.

14,000 UK businesses a year, per government research. Here is the one process to fix before Q4, and how an AI agent can take the chasing off you.

[SWIPE >>](#)



01 / 07

Pick the process that breaks first when volume doubles

Ask which job makes you stay late in a busy week. For most small firms it is getting paid: raising invoices, then chasing them. Fix that one, not five.

START WITH

Write down the one task that backed up worst last December.



02 / 07

Put the steps on one page

Who raises the invoice, when it goes, who chases and on which day. If it lives in one person's head, it breaks the week they are off sick.

START WITH

List every step from finished job to money in the bank.



03 / 07

Invoice the day the work is done

Every day you wait is a day added to the payment clock. Put the due date and your terms on the invoice itself, in writing, every time.

START WITH

Send today's invoice before you close the laptop.



04 / 07

Let software send the reminders

Xero, QuickBooks and most accounting tools can email a reminder before the due date, on it and a week after. The trade-off: automated nudges can feel cold, so call your biggest customers yourself.

START WITH

Switch on automatic reminders for your smaller accounts.



05 / 07

Hand the chasing to an AI agent

Chasing costs the average affected firm 86 hours a year. An agent linked to your accounts can spot overdue invoices each morning, draft the right reminder for each customer and flag who needs a call. Xero's own data says invoices with online payment options get paid up to twice as fast. Trade-off: you approve every message before it sends.

START WITH

Ask an AI assistant to draft three reminder emails today, then load them into your accounting tool.



06 / 07

Know what the law already lets you do

You can already charge statutory interest and a fixed fee on late commercial invoices. A Bill now in the Lords proposes a 60-day cap and new powers for the Small Business Commissioner. It is not law yet, so do not rely on it.

START WITH

Add a late-payment interest line to your standard terms.



07 / 07

Time one week before the rush

Count the hours the process eats this week. Government research puts the average affected firm at 86 hours a year chasing money it is already owed. Beat your own number before December, not after.

START WITH

Log your chasing time for seven days and keep the total.



Fix one process. Before the rush.

We would start with getting paid, then let an AI agent do the chasing while you approve the messages. Dull, measurable, and it decides whether a busy quarter turns into cash.

**Which process in your business
breaks first when things get busy?**